# MIKEROBERTSON18PLAYERSEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we are here at the International Golf Travel Market in Khan on the French Riviera on the Côte d'Azur and we have Mike Robinson from a great company called 18 Players UK. Mike, welcome to the program. Yeah, thanks very much for having me.

It's the end of the week, isn't it? So I'm sure we're all a bit tired but it's been fantastic, so yeah, thank you. IGTM is such a great industry event for the golfers all around the world, not only the golfers but the industry itself. Tell us about 18 players, but before we do that, tell us a bit about yourself first.

A, I'm an avid golfer. I've loved the game of golf since I was young. I'm very lucky now to call this work, so 18 players are a content marketing and PR specialist in the golf agency, so we're very lucky to be able to work with clients like the PGA, the RNA, GCMA, 20 golf clubs in Britain, so really high-end places like Royal St. George's, Royal Birkdale, Trune, Westingales, NAN.

And we also work with IGTM, which is why I'm here. Luckily enough, get to go to the show every year. It always amazes me to see the scale of which it kind of grows year on year and the new destinations that are coming in each year and places that I haven't been to play golf yet, but by the end of the week I'm like desperate to go play all of them.

It's a magnificent event and it's so relaxed and easy to get around. Some of these shows are absolutely massive and this show is super compact and I find that that's a lot better. Some of the bigger shows it's a bit overwhelming.

Yeah, it certainly is and I think that it's really nice the way this is set up because you've got the Golf Day on the Monday, which is quite an informal kind of start to the week. You do see a lot of the same faces year on year, but there's always new people that are coming in and that is just a real kind of soft launch to what is then a productive three days of business. Like I said, by the end of it you're tired, but it's certainly not on the scale of a WTM where you can't possibly see everything.

18 players, tell us about that company you work with and tell us about some of the big other companies that you work with to help them with their marketing. A really good example that we always give is Nairn Golf Club, which is in the Highlands in Scotland, one of the absolute best golf courses in Great Britain and they outsource all of their marketing, their PR, their social media management, their web design directly to 18 players. So we've played a real part in helping Nairn to kind of tell their story, find what makes them unique and just have the ability to kind of broadcast that out to people all around the world to make them want to go to visit Nairn.

We've helped them climb up the golf course rankings, which we always believe are kind of really critical in a golfers mind eye of where they might want to go play next. So they're a really good example of kind of a full kind of turnkey solution of clubs that we work with. How did you get into

this Mike? What was your background earlier? Play golf and was he really passionate about it? And then you moved into this area or did you come from another industry? I have always done agency style work, but I was desperate to get into a job in golf.

I mean, you're so lucky if you get to love what you do for work. So I was kind of desperate to get in. Luckily enough, came across a job interview at 18 players during Covid actually, so it's quite an odd time.

And then I can kind of hand on heart say I've not had a bad day in work since then. I've done a few things here. So we chaired a session with Terry Sims, who's the managing director of Silvermere to look at different revenue streams outside of just the golf course.

It was actually my colleague Tom who delivered the presentation on how to market a top 100 golf resort. He does that on the back of a lot of the work that I do because I'm our account director. But that was a full session on the importance of rankings, the importance of content, the importance of working with the right influences, with the right media, all to benefit you as a resort.

There's so many of them here. So they, you know, hopefully they took a lot out of that session. I thought it was really well delivered.

Khan itself, I suppose you've been coming here for a couple of years now with IGTM. What are your opinions of Khan, the city? Beautiful. We were very unlucky with the weather on the Tuesday.

It kind of poured down, but the last two days have been absolutely beautiful. So it's a really nice walk down from the hotel where we're staying to the exhibition center. And I just think it's a really cool city.

There's loads of nice restaurants, loads of nice bars. You see a lot of the people from the show out and about. So you're bound to have a good night here.

And what are future plans for our team players? What are you looking at in the future? We're also sister company to National Club Golfer, which is a big media brand in the UK website magazine, and we create a lot of our own content. So we have a YouTube series called 48 Hours In, which we would love people to check out. And the premise behind that is that that is us traveling to great golfing destinations.

We play four golf courses in 48 hours and document the whole thing. So it's not trying to break a score. It's just telling people about the best trips that you can make in golf, some of the off course activities, some about the history and the architecture of the golf course.

And that is a series that we really, really want to keep going with. It's been so well received. So we've got big plans for that in the new year.

We're filming at Sawgrass in January, and then we're going to loads of different places kind of right throughout Europe. And I suppose, you know, the production value that we can achieve these days in 4k, 6k is just magnificent with a good production company. You can get really world-class looking content.

Yeah, we're very lucky with that. Our videographer and editor is one of the absolute best. So we're always, you know, once we go out and film these things, Tom and I, who are the feature of these films, are always kind of eagerly anticipating seeing the first edit, and we're always blown away.

I get quite emotional watching them back. It's like reliving a great golf trip. But the production quality that you can put out now with the right people is incredible.

And that's the point now. You, the internet and YouTube and other platforms have really leveled the playing field for people who want to create their own content and reach very large audiences. Yeah, absolutely.

And there's obviously a massive amount of content that is available on YouTube. So not all of it is amazing. But if you, you know, you can find things that are of interest to you.

And I think that's how this series was birthed to us, really. We like to go on golf trips. We love to go play great golf courses.

So we thought, what a better way to just kind of document that. And luckily, it's been extremely well received. Mike Robertson, how can people find more about 18 players online? The website is 18players.com and my name's Mike Robertson to find me on LinkedIn or I have a quite a growing social page called Mike from 18 players on Instagram.

So we post all the video stuff that we do on there. We post a lot of client stuff on there. So we'd love people to check it out.

And we will make the point. It's the word 18 but one eight players United Kingdom Mike Robertson. Thank you so much for being on the program on Travel Radio Australia and keep doing what you guys do.

It's very good. Thanks very much chef present.